

International Student Services

Social Security Information

If you are an international student in F-1 or J-1 status, the Social Security Administration (SSA) will only issue a Social Security Number (SSN) to you for purposes of employment. The SSA will not issue an SSN for you to open a bank account, rent an apartment, apply for a driver's license or sign up for service. Use this link to learn more about an SSN for International Students: [International Students and Social Security Numbers](#)

Step 1: Obtain employment/ Written Offer

- To apply for an SSN, you must be first offered a job.
- On-campus employment:** please have your hiring department write an offer letter: The letter must be on letterhead and include the student's name, position being offered, and general description of the job duties, the anticipated or actual start date, number of hours per week, the Employer Identification Number (EIN), the immediate supervisor's name, title, and phone number.
- Off-campus employment requires pre-authorization from ISS. Please see website for details about OPT and CPT:** You must get a letter from the employer offering you employment. The letter must be on letterhead and must include the student's name, position being offered, and general description of the job duties, the anticipated or actual start date, number of hours per week, the Employer Identification Number (EIN), the immediate supervisor's name, title, and phone number.

Step 2: Obtain Permission from the ISS office for On-Campus Employment- SSN Support Letter

- You must submit the following documents to our office (iss@csudh.edu) to obtain an SSN Support Letter
 - Job Offer Letter
 - Job/Position Description
- Please allow a **minimum of 7 to 10 business days Monday-Friday** to create the SSN Support Letter

Step 3: Documents Needed to Apply for a Social Security Number

- The Social Security Administration Office requires that you bring the following **ORIGINAL** documents listed below by employment type to apply. You cannot apply for an SSN more than 30 days before the employment start date.
- You can use this link to start an Online SSN Application: <https://secure.ssa.gov/ossnap/public/landingOSSnap>
After completing the application you will have 45 days to schedule and visit the Social Security Administration office to finish your SSN application.

F-1 On-Campus Employment	F-1 on OPT	F-1 on CPT
- Passport - Visa Stamp - I-94 Document - I-20/DS-2019 - Offer letter from department - ISS letter	- Passport - Visa Stamp - I-94 Document - I-20 - EAD Card <i>If applicable:</i> Job Offer Letter	- Passport - Visa Stamp - I-94 Document - I-20 (with CPT approval on pg. 3) <i>*Do Not apply for an SSN more than 30 days before your CPT start date</i>

Step 4: Scheduling an Appointment at the Social Security Administration

- The closest Social Security Administration offices and office hours are below.

Long Beach 2005 Long Beach Blvd. Long Beach, CA 90806	Lakewood 4957 Paramount Blvd. Lakewood, CA 90712	Office Hours: Monday: 9am- 4pm Tuesday: 9am- 4pm Wednesday: 9am- 12pm Thursday: 9am- 4pm Friday: 9am-4pm	Phone Number: 1-800-772-1213 Website: www.ssa.gov
Torrance 22600 Crenshaw Blvd. Torrance, CA 90505	Anaheim 900 S. Harbor Blvd. Anaheim, CA 92805		

IMPORTANT: Processing time for an SSN is a minimum of 30 days. You will receive your Social Security card in the mail. To protect your identity, keep your Social Security card in a safe location. Never provide your SSN to an unidentified person over the phone or email.

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